



**STORE
ACTIVATION
MOCK PROJECT**

INTRO



This is a mock project for a store launch activation for Blank Street Coffee in Nottingham, set in Spring 2026. The aim is to explore how Blank Street could enter a new UK city while maintaining its accessible pricing and recognisable aesthetic.

The idea came up from my personal experience discovering Blank Street in Manchester, followed by noticing the brand's expansion across UK cities but Nottingham despite its large student population and strong café culture. This gap presented an opportunity to imagine how Blank Street would set up in Notts.

This project positions the brand as an everyday study and social space woven into campus life.



CAMPAIGN OVERVIEW

Campaign Name: Classroom to Coffeehouse

Location: Nottingham

Audience: University students (NTU & University of Nottingham)

Timing: Spring 2026 (summer vibes)

Goal: Position Blank Street as Nottingham's go-to coffee and matcha spot — a social, aesthetic third space for studying, unwinding, and connecting.



INSIGHTS



Nottingham is home to over thousands of students, dominating their presence in shaping city life and culture. (NTU 2025)

It is clear that student culture thrives on:

Affordable indulgences: 72% of students have changed their coffee-buying habits due to cost increases... quality and price are among the top considerations. (Professional 2025)

Aesthetic spaces: Students select coffee shops based on environment and space... reflecting usage as informal learning and social places. (Nhu Nguyen et al. 2025)

Community-driven experiences: Cafés are no longer just transactional; they offer meaningful experiences, community engagement, and immersive environments (Karim 2025)



CORE CONCEPT

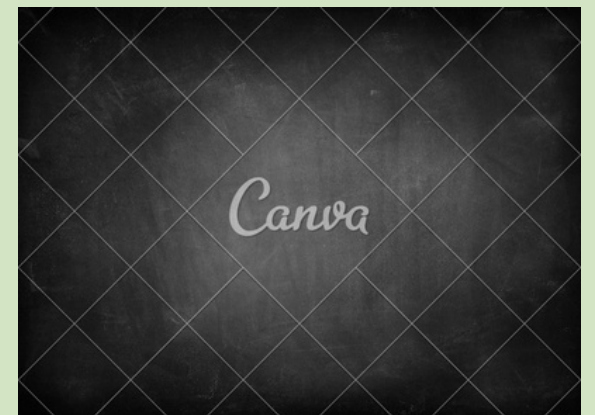


Core Concept

Classroom to Coffeehouse

Blank Street changes study culture into a modern coffee ritual where lectures, notes, and study breaks evolve into matcha, playlists, and chill sessions.

Think chalkboards, post-it notes, classroom references aligned with Blank Street's signature green, music, and matcha-led culture.



PHASE 1

The Tease

Timeline: 3 weeks pre-launch

Objective: Build curiosity and anticipation on campus.

Activations:

- Instagram story teasers:
- Pop-up announcement reveal:
- Old Market Square with exclusive 10% student discount.

PHASE 2



Pop-Up Activation

The Study Session Café

Timeline: 2 weeks pre-launch

A classroom-inspired pop-up blending with Blank Street's modern café culture.

Design & Experience:

- Teacher's desk reimagined as the coffee counter
- Chalkboard menus & post-it note walls
- Green tiles, disco lighting, and Blank Street FM playing throughout

Interactive Touchpoints:

- QR codes for app downloads to get discounts on first 3 orders in store
- "Leave a Note" wall: messages to other students
- Photo-ready corners for UGC

PHASE 3



Store Launch

Launch Message: “Hey Nottingham, we’re home.”

Launch Day Activations:

- First 50 drinks free
- Basketball hoop challenge to win Blank Street merch
- Flower-making corner & guided coffee tastings
- Blank Street FM playlist + branded photo walls

PHASE 4

The Afterglow

Objective: Sustain momentum post-launch.

Content Strategy:

- **90s Film-style reels featuring:**
 - Matcha pours
 - Study sessions
 - Handwritten post-it notes
- **Caption prompts:** “Study breaks just got sweeter”

DIGITAL ENGAGEMENT STRATEGY



- Repost student-generated content
- Launch hashtag: #StudyBreakWithBlankStreet
- Community-sourced Blank Street FM playlists

STUDENT OFFERS & RETENTION

- Matcha Study Hours: weekday student ID discounts
- Campus Coffee Crawl: collaborations with university societies
- Small pop-ups in uni libraries

This would encourage habit-building, not one-off visits.

KPIs

- +25% app downloads among students
- High UGC volume within first launch week
- Strong campus visibility and word-of-mouth traction
- Increased brand recall as a student lifestyle space, not just a café in Notts

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